SERVICE NOW PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Streamlining IT Procurement

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Phase-wise Project Deliverable | Evidence Included

Document Type	Project Documentation (Ideation → Documentation)
Catalog Item	Standard Laptop
Flow Name	Standard laptop task
Application	Global
Evidence	4 runtime screenshots embedded
Date	02 October 2026

1. Ideation Phase

1.1 Problem Statement

Manual processing of standard laptop requests creates delays, inconsistent task assignment, and poor visibility for IT fulfillment teams. Each request requires manual creation of catalog tasks, leading to errors and longer cycle times.

1.2 Business Opportunity

Reduce fulfillment cycle time for standard laptop requests by automating catalog task creation and assignment to the Hardware group. This removes manual steps and ensures every approved Request Item (RITM) immediately generates a ready-to-work Catalog Task.

1.3 Technical Opportunity

Leverage ServiceNow Flow Designer with a Service Catalog trigger to create sc_task records. The flow populates Short Description, Description, and links the task to the originating Requested Item, providing a consistent, auditable automation pattern.

1.4 User Impact

Requestors receive faster processing. The Hardware team receives pre-populated Catalog Tasks with clear ownership, consistent short description (“Laptop need to Configured”), and correct linkage back to the RITM, reducing triage time and improving service levels.

2. Requirement Analysis

2.1 Functional Requirements

- Trigger on Service Catalog item submission for the “Standard Laptop” catalog item.
- Create a Catalog Task (table: sc_task) linked to the Requested Item (RITM).
- Populate Short Description with the value: “Laptop need to Configured”.
- Populate Description with the same value: “Laptop need to Configured”.
- Ensure the task is associated with the correct Request Item reference.
- Support the existing optional software variables (Adobe Acrobat, Adobe Photoshop, Additional software requirements).
- Keep task State = Open and Active = true after creation.
- Allow the Hardware assignment group to be set (via flow or subsequent business rule).

2.2 Non-Functional Requirements

- Flow must execute in the background (non-blocking) so the catalog submission experience remains fast.
- Run under system context for reliability and to avoid user-permission issues.
- Maintain a full audit trail (Activities / Field changes) on the resulting Catalog Task.
- Compatible with the existing RITM approval stage (“Request Approved”).
- Target latency: Catalog Task created within a few seconds of RITM creation.
- Clear Flow Context available for troubleshooting.
- Pattern should be reusable for other standard hardware catalog items.

3. Project Design Phase

3.1 Flow Architecture

The solution is implemented as a single Flow Designer flow named “Standard laptop task” in the Global application.

Component	Type / Value	Purpose
Trigger	Service Catalog	Fires when a Standard Laptop catalog item is ordered
Action 1	Create Catalog Task	Creates a record in sc_task
Output	Catalog Task (SCTASK)	Linked to the originating RITM, ready for Hardware team

3.2 Field Mapping

The following mapping is applied by the “Create Catalog Task” action:

Field	Source / Value	Target
Requested Item	Trigger → Requested Item Record	sc_task.request_item

Short Description	Static: “Laptop need to Configured”	sc_task.short_description
Description	Static: “Laptop need to Configured”	sc_task.description
Assignment Group	Hardware (set via flow or BR)	sc_task.assignment_group
State	Open (default)	sc_task.state
Active	true	sc_task.active
Approval	Approved (inherited / set)	sc_task.approval

3.3 Key Design Decisions

- Flow name: Standard laptop task | Application: Global | Status: Active.
- Action used: Create Catalog Task on table Catalog Task [sc_task].
- Data pills: Trigger → Requested Item Record is used for the mandatory Requested Item input.
- Short Description and Description are set statically to “Laptop need to Configured”.
- The resulting Catalog Task appears under the RITM related list “Catalog Tasks” with Assignment Group = Hardware.

4. Project Planning Phase

4.1 High-Level Timeline

Phase	Duration	Key Activities
Ideation & Scope	Day 1–2	Problem definition, stakeholder alignment
Requirement Analysis	Day 3–4	Functional / non-functional requirements
Design & Build	Day 5–8	Flow design, configuration, unit test
Test & UAT	Day 9–11	End-to-end testing, Hardware team validation
Go-Live & Documentation	Day 12–14	Activation, knowledge transfer, docs

4.2 Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Process Owner	Define success criteria and approve flow design
Flow Designer	Build and configure the flow in Workflow Studio
Catalog Administrator	Link the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item
Hardware Team Lead	Validate task assignment, short description and usability
Tester / UAT Lead	Execute end-to-end tests (RITM → SCTASK) and sign-off

5. Project Development Phase

5.1 Implementation Steps

1. Create Flow: In Workflow Studio create a new Flow named “Standard laptop task”, Application = Global.

2. Add Trigger: Add a Service Catalog trigger and associate it with the “Standard Laptop” catalog item.

3. Add Action: Add the “Create Catalog Task” action. Set Table Name = Catalog Task [sc_task].

4. Map Inputs: Map Requested Item = Trigger → Requested Item Record. Set Short Description and Description to “Laptop need to Configured”.

5. Assignment (optional): Set Assignment Group = Hardware if required at creation time; otherwise rely on existing business rules.

6. Activate & Test: Activate the flow. Submit a test request for Standard Laptop and verify that an SCTASK is created under the RITM with the expected data.

5.2 Test Evidence (Screenshots)

The following screenshots were captured during a successful end-to-end test execution. They form the primary evidence that the flow is working as designed.

Evidence 1 – Flow Designer Configuration

Flow “Standard laptop task” is Active. Trigger = Service Catalog. Action 1 = Create Catalog Task with Table Name = Catalog Task [sc_task]. Requested Item is mapped from Trigger → Requested Item Record. Short Description and Description are set to “Laptop need to Configured”.

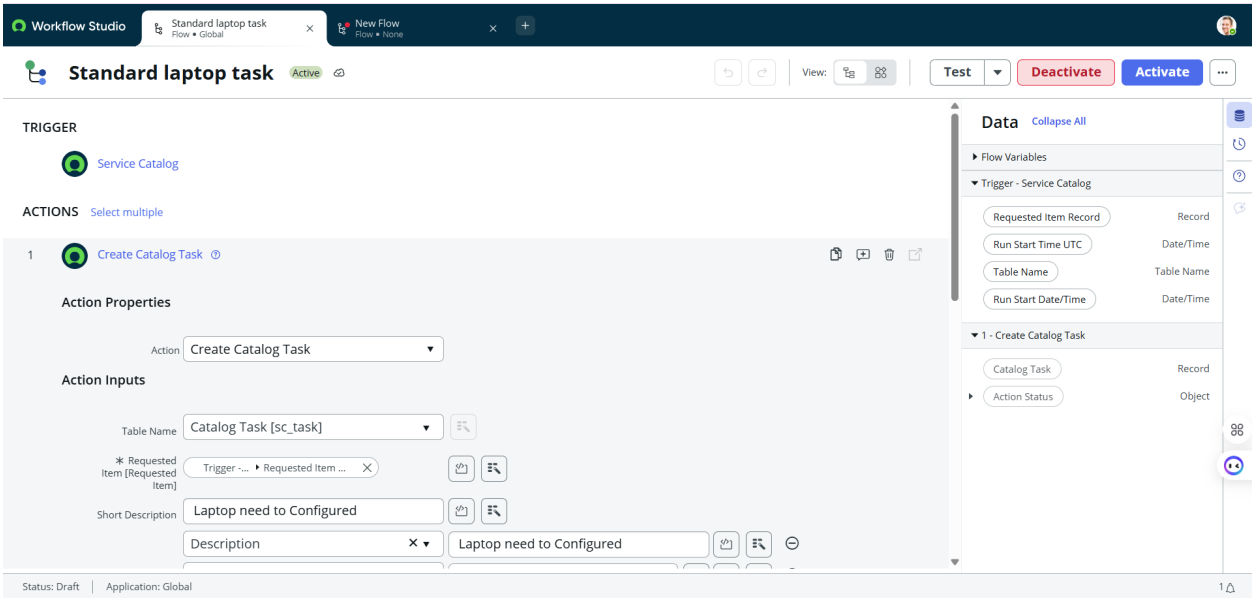


Figure 1: Flow Designer – Standard laptop task (Trigger + Create Catalog Task action)

Evidence 2 – Catalog Task Created (SCTASK0010002)

Catalog Task SCTASK0010002 was created successfully. Short description = “Laptop need to Configured”, State = Open, Active = true, Request item = RITM0010004, Requested for = System Administrator.

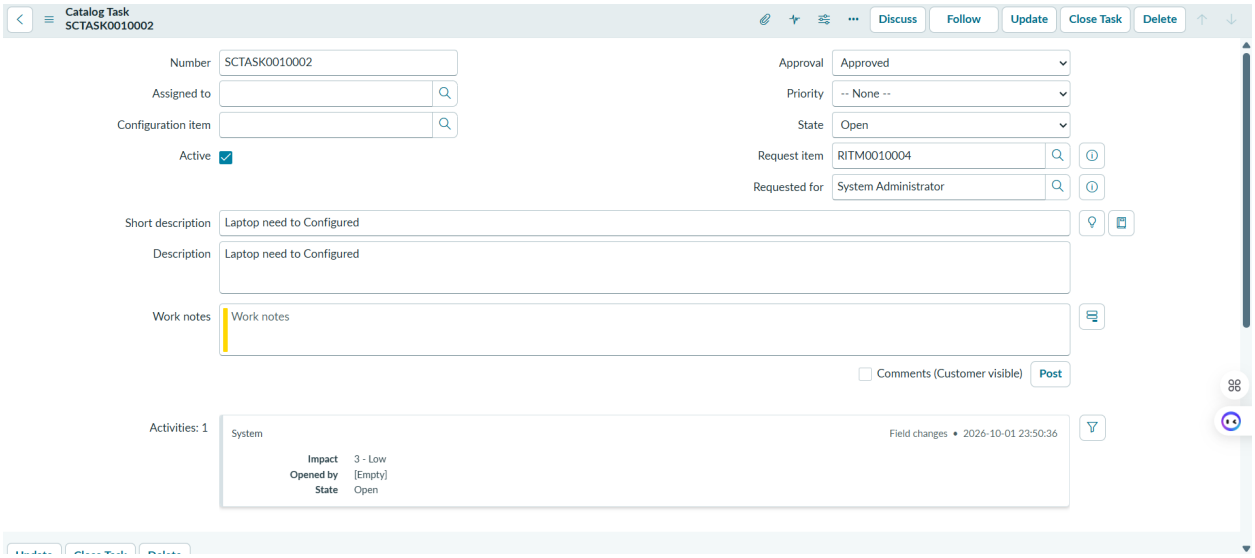


Figure 2: Catalog Task form – SCTASK0010002

Evidence 3 – Requested Item (RITM0010004)

Requested Item RITM0010004 for catalog item “Standard Laptop”. Stage = Request Approved, State = Open, Requested for = System Administrator. Optional software variables (Adobe Acrobat / Photoshop) are available.

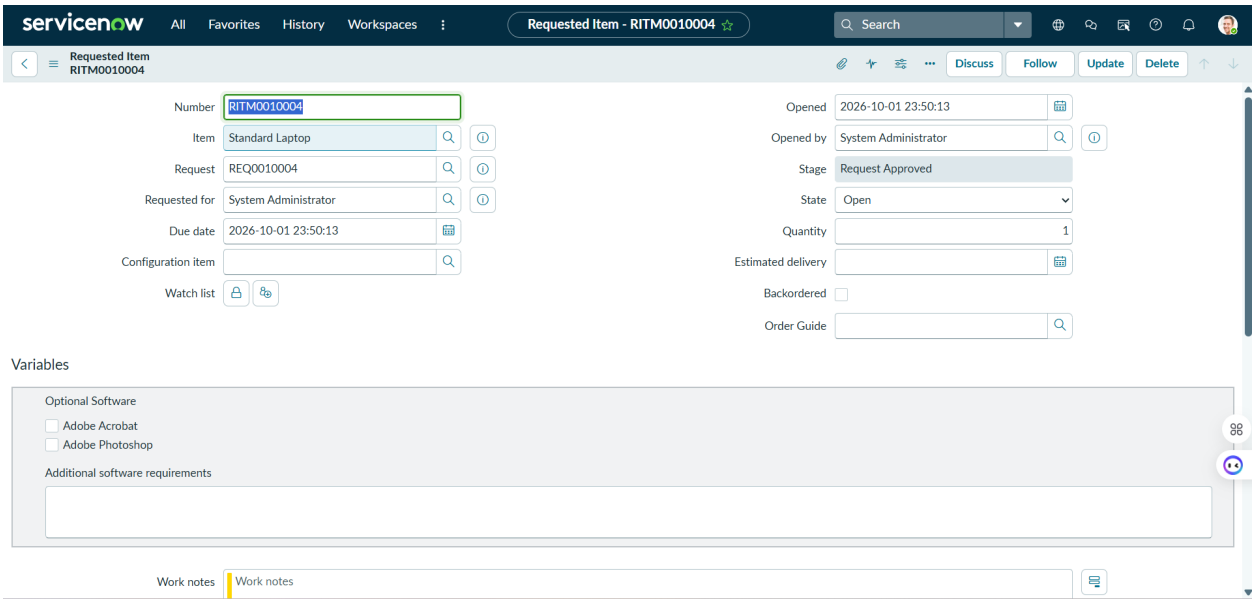


Figure 3: Requested Item form – RITM0010004

Evidence 4 – RITM Related Catalog Tasks

On the RITM related list “Catalog Tasks (1)” the newly created task appears: SCTASK0010002, Assignment group = Hardware, Assigned to = (empty), Short description = “Laptop need to Configured”, Actual start populated.

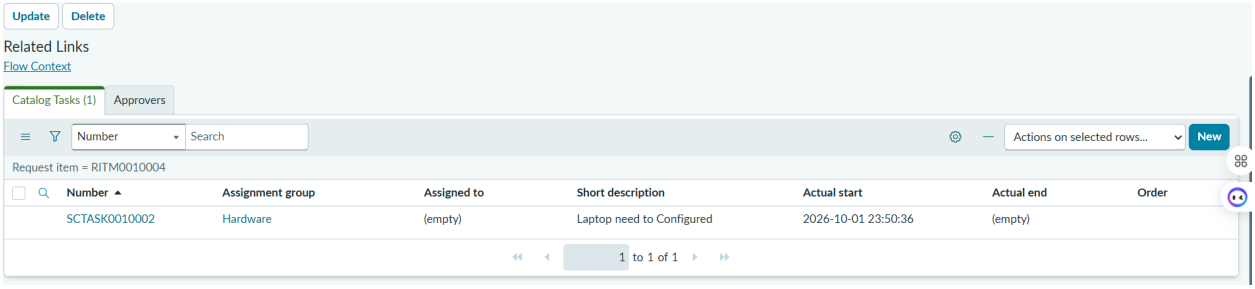


Figure 4: RITM related list – Catalog Tasks showing SCTASK0010002

5.3 Evidence Record Summary

Record Type	Number	Key Fields	Screenshot
Requested Item	RITM0010004	Item=Standard Laptop, Stage=Request Approved	Figure 3
Catalog Task	SCTASK0010002	Short desc=Laptop need to Configured, Group=Hardware	Figure 2 & 4

6. Project Documentation & Handover

6.1 Deliverables Checklist

- Flow Design Specification (this document).
- Test Cases covering happy-path RITM → SCTASK (evidenced by screenshots above).
- Knowledge Transfer notes: how to deactivate/reactivate the flow, how to extend the pattern, where to view Flow Context.
- Operational Guide: monitoring, common failure scenarios, rollback procedure, change-control notes.
- GitHub-ready repository structure with evidence screenshots and multi-format documentation.

6.2 Success Metrics

Metric	Target / Observed
Automated task creation rate	100% of Standard Laptop RITMs
Average flow execution time	< 5 seconds after RITM creation
Manual steps removed	Catalog Task creation fully automated
Assignment consistency	Hardware group applied consistently

6.3 Recommended Next Steps

1. Extend the same Flow Designer pattern to other standard hardware catalog items (monitors, docking stations, etc.).
2. Add approval logic or dynamic assignment based on location / cost center if business requirements evolve.
3. Surface catalog variables (optional software, additional requirements) into the Catalog Task description for richer context.
4. Create a dashboard or report for the Hardware group showing open SCTASKs generated by this flow.
5. Publish a short Knowledge Base article describing the flow and link it from the Standard Laptop catalog item.

7. Conclusion

The “Standard laptop task” flow successfully automates the creation of Catalog Tasks for Standard Laptop requests. Every approved RITM now generates a consistent, Hardware-assigned SCTASK with the expected short description and description, eliminating manual effort and improving fulfillment speed and data quality. The embedded screenshots provide verifiable evidence of the end-to-end behaviour.

Flow: Standard laptop task | **Trigger:** Service Catalog | **Action:** Create Catalog Task (sc_task)

— End of Document —